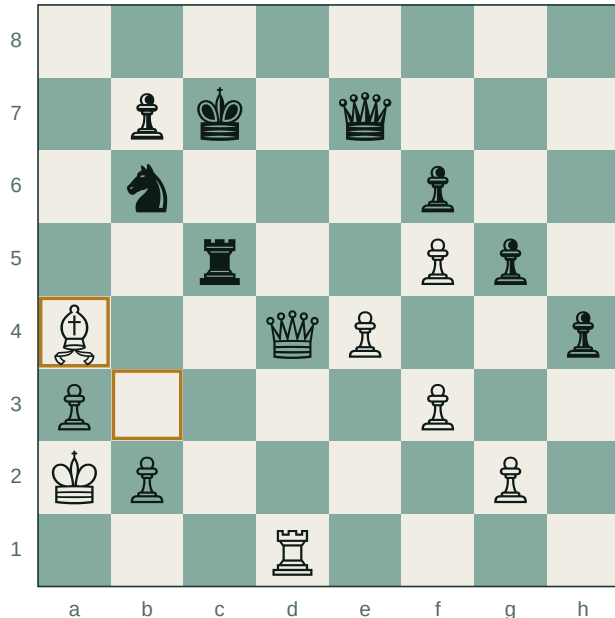


Interference tactics: Black, move 36

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Bxa4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...Rc4 37. Qd3 Rxa4

36...Rc4 The rook moves from c5 to c4. From c4 it attacks queen on d4 and bishop on a4. Recorded reply: **37.Qd3**.

37...Rxa4 The rook captures the bishop on a4.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on a2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.